

The C major scale

This scale follows the major pattern of whole steps and half steps without having to use any of the black keys of the keyboard—it has no sharps or flats. The whole steps skip over the black keys, while the half steps are between white keys that sit next to each other.

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▷ **From C to C**
Shown here on the keyboard, and below on the staff, the C major scale rises from Middle C to the C one octave above.

REAL WORLD

C major scale

Anyone who plays a musical instrument or takes music exams has to learn and practice scales. The C major scale is one of the first scales that a musician will learn on the piano because it has no sharps or flats.

▷ Practicing scales

Musicians understand how music works by practicing scales. This improves their technique on an instrument.

